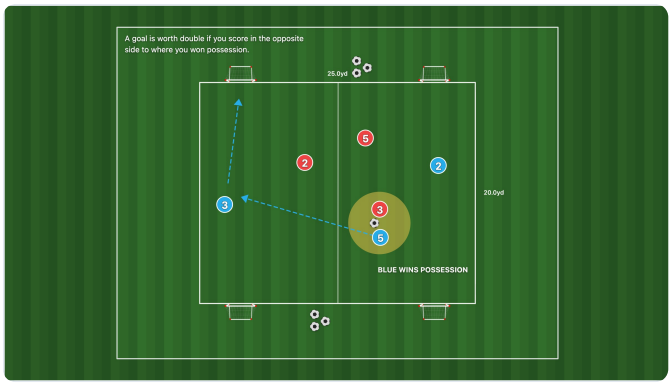
PITCHLABS

SWITCH OF PLAY TO FOUR GOALS

15 MIN | U8–U12 | POSSESSION | PASSING

OBJECTIVE

Win the ball, then look for the open side before committing: switch play away from where you won it rather than driving at the nearest goal.



PREPARATION

25 × 20 yd area split into two halves with a line down the middle. Two small goals at each end, one in each half. Spare balls at both ends so play restarts straight away.

EQUIPMENT

- ☐ 4 small goals
- ☐ 6+ balls
- ☐ Cones
- ☐ Bibs (2 colors)

PLAYERS

5–8 players

Medium Grid

FIELD SIZE 25 x 20yd

ORGANIZATION

3v3 (or 4v4), no goalkeepers. Each team attacks the two goals at one end and defends the two at the other. A normal goal counts 1. A goal scored in the half opposite to where your team won the ball counts double. After a goal or when the ball goes out, restart from a spare ball.

RULES

- Score in either goal you're attacking: 1 point
- Score on the opposite side to where you won the ball: 2 points
- No goalkeepers
- Restart straight away from the spare balls

PROGRESSIONS

- Switched goals count triple, or only switched goals count
- Narrow the area (e.g. 25 × 15 yd) for more pressure and quicker decisions
- A touch limit, set to what your players can manage

REGRESSIONS

- Add a neutral who plays for whichever team has the ball
- Make the area bigger (e.g. 30 × 25 yd)
- Drop the double-goal rule until players can keep the ball

COACHING POINTS

- Look to the far side before the ball arrives
- First touch away from pressure, toward the open side
- When your team wins it, get wide on the far side
- If the near goal is open, take it, since switching isn't the only right answer

QUESTIONS FOR PLAYERS

"Where did we win the ball, and which side is open now?"

"Who can see the far goal?"

"When is the near goal the better choice?"